

FRONT OFFICE · ROSTER · RUMOR MILL

NEW ENGLAND PATRIOTS

INTEL REPORT

2026 training camp edition — defending AFC champions, A.J. Brown in the building, and one starter whose attendance is still an open question.

UPDATED
July 25, 2026

14–3	AFC Champs	Drake Maye	A.J. Brown	Thru Aug 20
2025 RECORD	LOST SB LX 29–13	MVP RUNNER-UP	JUNE TRADE	CAMP AT GILLETTE

◆ FRONT OFFICE & LEADERSHIP

- ◆ **From worst to the Super Bowl.** New England went 14–3, beat the Chargers and Texans, took the AFC Championship from Denver 10–7, and lost Super Bowl LX to Seattle 29–13.
- ◆ **The stated goal for camp:** "weaponize Drake's mind" as Maye enters his second season in **Josh McDaniels'** system — less installation, more autonomy.
- ◆ **The front office spent like a contender**, adding a receiver in free agency and then paying a first-round pick for a second one in June.
- ◆ **REALITY CHECK** ESPN's Football Power Index does not rank the defending AFC champions as the best team in their own division — Buffalo is ahead of them, and New England sits **seventh in the conference**.

◆ TRADES & MAJOR TRANSACTIONS

- ◆ **TRADE** **A.J. Brown from Philadelphia**, completed in June, for a **first- and a fifth-round pick**. From 2022–25 no receiver in football commanded a larger share of his team's receiving yards.
- ◆ **SIGNED** WR **Romeo Doubs** — the big-ticket offensive acquisition before Brown, giving Maye two new outside targets.
- ◆ **SIGNED** Further **offensive line investment**, the quieter priority of the offseason and the one that keeps Maye upright.
- ◆ **ADDED** TE **Eli Raridon** — another pass-catching option in a room that needed one.
- ◆ **Chemistry started early:** Brown wasted no time working with Maye at minicamp.

◆ PLAYER UPDATES & CAMP BATTLES

- ◆ **Drake Maye, QB.** Led New England to a Super Bowl and finished **second in MVP voting**. With Brown and Doubs added, the coaching staff believes he can be more dangerous in Year 2 of McDaniels' offense.
- ◆ **ATTENDANCE** **Christian Gonzalez, CB.** Whether the star corner is at camp at all is the question ESPN built its entire Patriots preview around — the single biggest unresolved item in the building.
- ◆ **A.J. Brown, WR.** Cost a first-rounder and immediately became the offense's focal point. Already building timing with Maye.
- ◆ **Romeo Doubs, WR.** Signed before Brown; now the complement rather than the centerpiece, which is a better job for him.
- ◆ **Gabe Jacas** is among the young defenders local coverage has flagged as a player to watch through August.
- ◆ **Camp runs through Aug. 20** at Gillette Stadium.

◆ LATEST ROSTER MOVES

MOVE	DETAIL
▲ A.J. Brown, WR	Trade with Philadelphia for a first and a fifth
▲ Romeo Doubs, WR	Free-agent signing
▲ Eli Raridon, TE	Added as a pass-catching option
▲ Offensive line	Further investment in protection
▼ 2028 first-round pick	Sent to Philadelphia in the Brown deal
▼ 2027 fifth-round pick	Also sent to Philadelphia

◆ THE BOTTOM LINE

New England got to a Super Bowl a year early and then behaved like a team that intends to go back: it bought the best available receiver with first-round capital and put him next to the MVP runner-up. The counterweight is that the models don't buy it — the Bills rank ahead of them, and Denver and Seattle both look the same as they did in January. **The one thing that could unravel a very good summer is Christian Gonzalez's attendance**, which is still unresolved as camp opens.